Contractor / Freelance CV



MARTIN GRELLMANN

Senior Engineer | Legacy Modernization | AI-Assisted Code Analysis | ABAP & PHP

Location: Goiás, Brazil (America/Sao_Paulo, BRT, UTC−03:00, no DST)

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German citizen with unrestricted work and residence permit in Brazil.

Languages: German — Native

English — Professional working proficiency

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Professional Profile

Senior engineer for legacy modernization, with a working method that combines AI-assisted code analysis with strict manual verification.

I take over systems nobody understands any more: undocumented ABAP applications from the nineties, heavily customized Drupal 7 multisites, grown PHP backends. AI helps me read and summarize large amounts of unknown code quickly; I verify every finding against the running system before anything is changed.

This is not a tooling experiment. It has been my daily work in two productive environments, one SAP and one PHP, and it shortens the analysis phase that used to make legacy projects unaffordable.

Value for Contract Roles

- Available as a contractor for legacy assessments and modernization programmes in SAP and PHP environments.
- Typical starting point: an application that still runs, nobody dares to change, and no documentation exists for.
- Deliverable is not only code: a documented map of the system, reconstructed business rules and a step-by-step plan the customer can also execute without me.
- AI is a tool in this work, not a promise. Every finding is verified before it is acted on.

How I Work on Legacy Systems

- Inventory first: what exists, what is really called, what is dead code.
- AI-assisted reading of the unknown code to get a fast first map of modules, dependencies and rules.
- Verification of every AI finding against the running system, the database and the people who use it. Nothing goes into a decision unverified.
- Documentation of the reconstructed rules before any rewrite, so the knowledge survives the project.
- Incremental rewrite with the safest slice first, each step releasable on its own.
- Handover: documentation, conventions and a working setup the customer team can continue with.

Professional Experience

Technical Lead / IT Specialist, Ferienhausvermittlung fincaferien **03/2025 to Present**
Düsseldorf, Germany

Technical lead for the rescue of a heavily customized Drupal 7 multisite platform with seven productive sites, an undocumented custom module base and a five-year maintenance backlog.

- Go-live of the rescued platform on 6 September 2026: all seven sites migrated to the new infrastructure without downtime, documentation and deployment path in place.
- Took over a Drupal 7 multisite system with no documentation, no environment separation and credentials committed in plain text, and brought it back under control.
- Used AI-assisted code analysis to read and summarize the undocumented custom modules, then verified every finding against the running system before acting on it.
- Introduced a clean settings split (versioned configuration, unversioned secrets), a redaction workflow for terminal output and pre-commit checks so credentials stop leaking.
- Separated development and production trees, moved the platform to cloud infrastructure and documented the previously undocumented deployment.
- Repaired the booking and availability processes and wrote the missing documentation as I went, so the knowledge no longer lives only in the code.

Technologies
Drupal 7, PHP, MySQL/MariaDB, Linux, Git, Drush, cloud infrastructure, AI-assisted code analysis, documentation.

Senior SAP Developer, intecsoft GmbH & Co. KG **01/2025 to 09/2026**
Dresden, Germany

Senior SAP development role focused on modernization, integration and software quality in S/4HANA projects.

- Reverse-engineered an undocumented SAP Business Suite Dynpro application in IS-U and rewrote it in object-oriented ABAP, using AI-assisted code reading to speed up the analysis of the original logic.
- Reconstructed and documented the business rules that only existed in the code.
- Rebuilt backend API interfaces in an S/4HANA customer project (SAP PSM) and extended the intecsoft SAP solution Collection Sense FI, keeping its productive services stable during hypercare.
- Worked with business teams and solution managers to confirm the reconstructed behaviour before replacing the old code.

Technologies
ABAP Objects, ABAP SQL, CDS Views, OData, SAP BTP, REST, Fiori/UI5, S/4HANA, Clean Core.

SAP Technical Consultant, BA Business Advice GmbH **02/2022 to 12/2024**
Oldenburg, Germany

SAP consulting and development with a focus on migration and refactoring of grown, poorly documented custom applications.

- Migrated and refactored twenty-year-old FI and PM custom applications from SAP R/3 to S/4HANA, starting from code with almost no documentation.
- Reconstructed business rules from grown procedural code and rewrote them as object-oriented ABAP.
- Contributed to a data migration from a self-developed C++ ERP system to S/4HANA.
- Worked in the cloud expert team for S/4HANA Cloud Public Edition, BTP and ABAP Clean Core.
- Delivered in the project areas PPDS, QM, LE and PM.

Technologies
ABAP, ABAP Objects, ABAP SQL, CDS Views, OData, SE80, Eclipse, S/4HANA, SAP BTP, Clean Core.

Software Developer and Linux Administrator, Sengicon GmbH **02/2021 to 01/2022**
Germany

Full-stack development with a focus on turning an outdated PHP application into a maintainable REST backend with a modern frontend.

- Rebuilt an outdated PHP web application into a PHP REST backend with a newly built React frontend, step by step and without stopping daily operations.
- Refactored grown PHP code and reshaped database schemas that had drifted from the data model.
- Refactored existing React components alongside the backend work.
- Administered Linux VMs and LAMP stacks for development and production.

Technologies
React, JavaScript, PHP, REST, PHPUnit, Jest, Linux, Apache, MySQL, MariaDB, PostgreSQL, Composer.

Webmaster / Web Developer, Ferienhaus-Vermittlung fincaferien.de GmbH **04/2002 to 12/2019**
Bockenem, Germany

Long-term responsibility for the web platform that I am modernizing again today, which gives me first-hand knowledge of how the legacy system grew. Started in 04/2002 as a part-time role of about ten hours per week alongside my apprenticeship as an Industrial Clerk, with full technical responsibility from 04/2004.

- Developed and maintained the Drupal 7 multisite platform and its custom modules from 2015 onwards.
- Introduced Git and Jira into a workflow that had none before.
- Increased organic traffic through technical SEO, performance and usability work.
- Managed Linux, Samba and Windows network environments.

Technologies
PHP, Drupal 7, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, MySQL, Git, Jira, Linux, Samba, SEO/SEA.

Selected Projects

Migration of custom applications from R/3 to S/4HANA **04/2024 to 09/2024**

- Refactored and migrated FI and PM custom applications to modern ABAP.
- Modernized applications that had grown over twenty years.

Data migration from a C++ ERP system to S/4HANA **03/2022 to 05/2022**

- Supported the migration of a self-developed ERP system to S/4HANA for a wire processing customer.

Bloom optimizer, custom ABAP application (PPDS) **05/2022 to 06/2024**

- Developed a bloom optimizer for a steel mill that plans rolling processes by steel grade, loading location, minimum remaining ends and technical constraints.
- Implemented in Eclipse and SE80 and integrated into PPDS.

Technical Skills

Legacy analysis	Reverse engineering of undocumented applications, dead code detection, dependency mapping, reconstruction and documentation of business rules, AI-assisted code reading with manual verification.
SAP	ABAP, ABAP Objects, ABAP SQL, Dynpro, CDS Views, OData, RAP, SAP BTP, S/4HANA, Clean Core, SE80, ABAP Development Tools for Eclipse.
Web	PHP, Drupal 7, Composer, JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Node.js, REST APIs, PHPUnit, Jest.
Data	MySQL, MariaDB, PostgreSQL, schema archaeology, migration of grown data models.
Operations	Linux administration, Apache, LAMP, Drush, cloud infrastructure, Git, environment separation, secret handling and credential rotation.
Method	Clean Code, SOLID, refactoring patterns, architecture documentation, incremental rewrite, Scrum (PSM I), Jira, OpenProject.

Education and Training

Software Architecture, Software Academy by intecsoft, Dresden, Germany **07/2025**
iSAQB CPSA-F Foundation Level training (online, 14–17 July 2025), certificate of attendance; exam planned for Q4/2026.

Full-Stack Web Developer, Indisoft GmbH, Germany **2020 to 2021**
Full-Stack Web Developer certification (HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP, React, databases).

Agile Project Management, Indisoft GmbH, Germany **05/2020 to 06/2020**
Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I), certified by Scrum.org in June 2020.

Industrial Clerk, DAA GmbH, Hildesheim, Germany **2002 to 2004**
Apprenticeship as Industrial Clerk (Industriekaufmann).

Certificates and References

- Reference letters on request.
- Certificates: Certificate of attendance CPSA-F (iSAQB training, 2025), Professional Scrum Master I (Scrum.org, 2020), Full-Stack Web Developer (2021), Agile Project Management (2021), Object-Oriented PHP (2020).